

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS

Magazine Builder

Phase A — the manual editor, designed for older adults

Version	1.0
Status	Draft for breakdown and build
Scope	Manual editor only. The AI generation layer is Phase B and is out of scope for this document.
Companion	Magazine Builder — Architecture Specification v0.2
Audience	Product, design, and the engineers and agents building each module

This document defines *what* the product must do and *how it must feel*. It deliberately contains no implementation detail — that lives in the architecture specification. Every requirement here carries a stable ID and a testable acceptance criterion so that work can be split across parallel workstreams without ambiguity about what "finished" means.

1. Purpose and scope

We are building a tool that lets people who are not designers, and who are not confident with computers, produce printed publications: community newsletters, club and church bulletins, family memory books, small magazines.

The product will eventually generate designs from a written brief. That capability is deliberately **not** in this document. We are building the manual editor first, to a high standard, because the AI layer produces ordinary documents that users then edit by hand — so the editor is the floor beneath everything. An excellent generator sitting on top of a frustrating editor is a frustrating product.

1.1 How to read this document

Every requirement has a stable identifier such as `TXT-04`. These identifiers never change and never get reused. Use them when assigning work, writing tests, filing defects, and discussing scope.

PRIORITY	MEANING
MUST	Required for first release. The product is not shippable without it.
SHOULD	Wanted for first release. Cut if it threatens quality or the date.
LATER	Explicitly deferred. Do not build in Phase A. Listed so nobody re-proposes it.

Each requirement includes a **Done when** line. That line is the acceptance test. If it cannot be demonstrated, the requirement is not complete, regardless of how much code exists.

1.2 What this document does not cover

- Implementation, data structures, and technical architecture — see the architecture specification
- The AI generation pipeline — Phase B
- Pricing, billing, and account management
- Marketing, onboarding funnels, and growth

2. Who we are building for

2.1 Primary user

An adult, typically 70 or older, who has used a computer for email, photographs, and web browsing, but has never used design software. They may have reduced fine motor control, reduced near vision, and low confidence around unfamiliar software — they worry about "breaking something" and will often stop rather than experiment.

They are not stupid, slow, or incapable, and the product must never treat them that way. They are unfamiliar with a set of conventions that designers take for granted, and unwilling to absorb a large amount of new vocabulary in order to make a newsletter.

2.2 Secondary user

A family member, volunteer, or staff member who helps set things up and is called when something goes wrong. They may be more confident, but they are not present most of the time. The product must be usable alone.

2.3 What they are making

Short publications, typically 4 to 24 pages, printed at home or at a local print shop. Text-led with photographs. Produced on a schedule — monthly or quarterly — which means the same person will use the tool repeatedly and must not have to relearn it each time.

2.4 The success test

PRIMARY ACCEPTANCE TEST FOR PHASE A

A person aged 70 or over, with no design experience and no training, can produce a printed four-page newsletter containing two photographs, a headline, and body text — in under 30 minutes, without asking anyone for help.

The same person can repeat the task a week later without relearning the tool.

This test governs the whole of Phase A. Run it with at least five real participants before any work begins on the AI layer. If it fails, no feature list rescues the product.

3. Design principles

These are constraints, not aspirations. Where a principle conflicts with a feature, the principle wins and the feature changes.

THE CENTRAL TENSION

"Match every Canva feature" and "usable by an 80-year-old" pull in opposite directions. Canva is dense by design: small targets, hover-revealed controls, contextual toolbars that appear and disappear, interactions that require a sustained drag. That density is what makes it powerful for its audience.

Our audience needs the opposite: fewer controls, larger targets, nothing hidden, and every action achievable without a drag. **Where the two conflict, ease of use wins.** Canva already owns "dense and powerful". Nobody owns "genuinely easy".

1. Nothing is hidden

If a control exists, it is visible on screen or one clearly labelled click away. Our users do not explore. They will not discover a feature that only appears on hover, on right-click, or after selecting the right object.

Forbids: hover-only toolbars, right-click-only actions, hamburger menus containing primary functions, controls that appear only in certain modes.

2. Nothing is lost

Every action can be undone. Every destructive action is confirmed in plain words first. Work saves continuously and visibly. The user must never have grounds to fear that clicking something will destroy their work — because that fear is what stops them using the tool at all.

Forbids: unconfirmed deletion, actions outside the undo history, silent failure, manual-save-only.

3. The screen holds still

Panels, toolbars, and buttons stay in the same physical position throughout. Users build muscle memory by location, not by icon recognition. A toolbar that reshapes itself according to selection forces re-orientation every single time.

Forbids: context-dependent toolbar layouts, panels that reorder, controls that move as content changes, floating toolbars that follow the selection.

4. Plain words only

The interface uses the words our users already know. Not one item of design or technical jargon appears anywhere in the product — not in buttons, labels, tooltips, error messages, or help text. Section 8 fixes the approved vocabulary.

Forbids: opacity, kerning, leading, z-index, bleed, CMYK, DPI, canvas, element, object, asset, export, render, layer.

5. Never drag-only

Dragging is difficult with tremor, arthritis, or a trackpad. Every operation achievable by dragging must also be achievable by selecting and then using a button, an arrow key, or a typed value.

Forbids: drag-and-drop as the sole means of any action, drag-to-reorder without buttons, resize handles without a numeric alternative.

6. No timing, ever

Nothing requires speed. No double-clicks, no press-and-hold, no messages that disappear on their own, no session timeouts that lose work.

Forbids: toast notifications that auto-dismiss, double-click-to-edit, long-press gestures, timed tutorials.

7. One obvious path

For each task there is one recommended way, presented prominently. Alternative routes may exist for confident users but are never given equal visual weight. Choice is a cost.

Forbids: three equally prominent ways to add a photo, panels with more than seven visible options, settings presented without a sensible default already chosen.

4. Global requirements

These apply to every screen and every feature in the product. They are not the responsibility of one team — each feature is checked against this list before it is considered complete.

GL-01 Minimum target size **MUST**

Every clickable control has a hit area of at least 44 × 44 pixels, including icon-only buttons. Adjacent controls have at least 8 pixels of separation.

Done when: an automated check over the rendered interface reports zero controls below the threshold.

GL-02 Interface text size **MUST**

No interface text is smaller than 16 pixels. A setting increases all interface text up to 24 pixels without breaking any layout.

Done when: every screen is inspected at both the default and maximum setting with no clipping, overlap, or scrollbars introduced.

GL-03 No hover-dependent controls **MUST**

No function is reachable only by hovering. Hover may enhance (a highlight, a tooltip) but never reveals a control that is otherwise unavailable.

Done when: every function in this document is demonstrated on a touch device, where hover does not exist.

GL-04 Non-drag alternative for every drag **MUST**

Moving, resizing, rotating, and reordering are each achievable without a sustained drag — by arrow keys, buttons, or typed values.

Done when: the full primary acceptance test (2.4) is completed using only clicks and keyboard, with no drag at any point.

GL-05 No timed or gestural interactions **MUST**

No double-click, press-and-hold, swipe, or auto-dismissing message anywhere in the product. Messages remain until dismissed by the user.

Done when: a code-level audit finds no double-click or long-press handlers, and no notification with an auto-dismiss timer.

GL-06 Universal undo **MUST**

Every action that changes the document can be undone, with at least 50 steps of history. A large, permanently visible Undo button sits in a fixed position. Redo sits beside it.

Done when: a script performing 50 varied actions followed by 50 undos returns the document to a state identical to the start.

GL-07 Confirmation before loss **MUST**

Deleting a page, deleting multiple items, or discarding changes requires confirmation. The message states in plain words what will be lost and what the user should click.

Done when: every destructive action is enumerated and each shows a confirmation reviewed against the Section 8 vocabulary.

GL-08 Approved vocabulary only MUST

All user-facing text uses the terms in Section 8. Forbidden terms appear nowhere in the interface, help, or error messages.

Done when: an automated scan of all user-facing strings against the forbidden-term list returns zero matches, and runs in the build pipeline.

GL-09 Stable layout MUST

The toolbar and side panels occupy the same position at all times. Selecting different item types changes which controls are *enabled*, never which are *present* or where they sit.

Done when: screenshots taken with a text item, an image, and a shape selected show controls in identical positions.

GL-10 Contrast and colour independence MUST

All interface text meets a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 against its background. No information is conveyed by colour alone; colour is always paired with a label, icon, or shape.

Done when: an automated accessibility audit reports zero contrast failures, and every colour-coded state is confirmed to carry a second signal.

GL-11 Browser zoom to 200% MUST

The interface remains fully functional at 200% browser zoom, with no clipped controls, horizontal scrolling, or overlapping panels.

Done when: the primary acceptance test is completed at 200% zoom.

GL-12 Actionable error messages MUST

Every error states what happened in plain words and what the user should do next. No error codes, no technical terms, no message that leaves the user without a next step.

Done when: every error state is catalogued with its message text, and each has been reviewed against this requirement.

GL-13 Full keyboard operation MUST

Every function is reachable by keyboard. Focus order follows visual order. The focused control is indicated by a clearly visible outline of at least 3 pixels.

Done when: the primary acceptance test is completed using keyboard only.

GL-14 Screen reader support MUST

Every control has an accessible name describing its function in plain words. Changes of state are announced. The page structure uses correct landmarks and headings.

Done when: a full pass with a screen reader completes the primary acceptance test.

GL-15 Panel option limit MUST

No panel presents more than seven options at once. Additional options sit behind a clearly labelled "More settings" control, and never include anything needed for the primary acceptance test.

Done when: every panel is counted and none exceeds seven visible options in its default state.

GL-16 Continuous saving MUST

Work saves automatically. A permanently visible indicator shows saved state in plain words. No user action is ever required to preserve work.

Done when: the browser is closed at ten random points during the acceptance test and no work is lost in any case.

5. Feature requirements

5.1 Documents and pages **DOC**

DOC-01 Home screen **MUST**

On opening the product, the user sees their existing documents as large visual previews with names and dates, plus one prominent button to start something new.

Done when: a first-time user identifies how to open an existing document and how to start a new one, without instruction.

DOC-02 Start from a template or blank **MUST**

Starting a new document offers a small set of ready-made designs shown as large previews, plus a blank option. At least six templates ship at launch.

Done when: selecting any template produces a complete, correctly laid out document ready to edit.

DOC-03 Page size **MUST**

Common sizes (A4, A5, US Letter, square) are offered by name with their real-world dimensions shown. A custom size can be entered in millimetres or inches.

Done when: each preset produces a document whose printed output measures correctly, verified against a physical print.

DOC-04 Add, delete, and duplicate pages **MUST**

Pages can be added at any position, removed, or copied. Deletion is confirmed per GL-07.

Done when: each operation works from both the page sidebar and the main menu, and is fully undoable.

DOC-05 Reorder pages **MUST**

Page order can be changed by dragging in the sidebar *and* by "Move up" / "Move down" buttons, satisfying GL-04.

Done when: pages are reordered successfully using only the buttons, with no drag.

DOC-06 Page sidebar **MUST**

A permanently visible sidebar shows every page as a numbered thumbnail. Clicking one moves to that page. The current page is clearly marked by more than colour alone.

Done when: a 24-page document scrolls smoothly in the sidebar and every thumbnail reflects current content within two seconds of a change.

DOC-07 Facing pages view **MUST**

Interior pages display side by side as they will appear in the finished publication. The front and back covers display singly. A toggle switches to single-page view.

Done when: a 12-page document displays as cover, five spreads, and back cover, matching the printed result.

DOC-08 Automatic page numbers SHOULD

Page numbers can be switched on for the whole document, with a choice of position. They renumber automatically when pages are added, removed, or reordered.

Done when: inserting a page at position 3 of a 10-page document correctly rennumbers all following pages.

DOC-09 Repeating background SHOULD

Items that appear on every page — a header, a footer, a border — are set up once and applied to all pages. Any page may opt out.

Done when: changing a repeating item updates every page that uses it, and pages that opted out are unaffected.

DOC-10 Rename and duplicate a document MUST

A document can be renamed at any time and copied whole, so a user can base next month's issue on last month's.

Done when: a duplicated document opens with all content intact and no shared state with the original.

DOC-11 Version history LATER

Restore the document to how it looked at an earlier point.

Done when: deferred to Phase B.

5.2 Text TXT**TXT-01 Add text** MUST

A clearly labelled "Add text" button places a text box on the page ready for typing. Users are never required to know that they must draw a box first.

Done when: a first-time user adds text and types into it within 30 seconds, without instruction.

TXT-02 Edit text in place MUST

Clicking once on existing text places a cursor for editing. Text is typed, selected, and corrected exactly as in a word processor, including copy and paste from other programs.

Done when: text pasted from a word processor and from a web page arrives with sensible formatting and no broken characters.

TXT-03 Font family MUST

Fonts are chosen from a list where each name is displayed *in that font*, at a readable size. Recently used fonts appear at the top.

Done when: the list renders every font in its own face, scrolls smoothly, and applies the selection immediately.

TXT-04 Upload your own font SHOULD

A font file can be uploaded and used in the document. If the font's licence forbids embedding in a PDF, the user is warned in plain words at upload time, not at export.

Done when: an uploaded font renders on screen and embeds correctly in the exported PDF, and a restricted font produces a warning at upload.

TXT-05 Text size MUST

Size is set by choosing from a list of common sizes, by typing an exact number, or by clearly labelled larger/smaller buttons.

Done when: all three methods work and produce identical results for the same value.

TXT-06 Text colour **MUST**

Colour is chosen from the document palette, from recently used colours, or from a full picker. See Section 5.6.

Done when: colour applies to a selected range of characters as well as to a whole text box.

TXT-07 Bold, italic, underline **MUST**

Available as three clearly labelled buttons showing their current on/off state by more than colour alone.

Done when: each applies to a selected range, and the button state reflects the selection accurately.

TXT-08 Alignment **MUST**

Left, centred, right, and "straight edges both sides" are offered as labelled buttons.

Done when: all four apply per paragraph, and justified text breaks correctly with no rivers at body size.

TXT-09 Line and letter spacing **SHOULD**

Presented as sliders labelled "Line spacing" and "Letter spacing", each with a plain-language description and a reset to default.

Done when: both adjust visibly and reset returns to the exact original value.

TXT-10 Bullets and numbered lists **SHOULD**

Two buttons convert selected paragraphs to a bulleted or numbered list, with correct indentation and hanging alignment.

Done when: lists render correctly in the exported PDF, including multi-line items.

TXT-11 Rotate text to any angle **MUST**

Text can be set at any angle, not only horizontal. Achievable by a rotate handle and by typing a number of degrees, per GL-04.

Done when: text at 37 degrees renders identically on screen and in the exported PDF, and remains editable in place.

TXT-12 Text continues in another box **MUST**

When text does not fit, the user connects the box to another one — on the same page or a later page — and the text continues into it automatically. Editing earlier text reflows everything after it.

Done when: a 3,000-word article flows across six connected boxes, and adding a sentence at the start correctly reflows all six.

TXT-13 Hidden text warning **MUST**

When text does not fit its box and is not continued elsewhere, a clear and unmissable warning appears on the box itself, stating that some text is hidden and offering to fix it.

Done when: the warning appears within one second of overflow occurring, and cannot be missed at a glance.

TXT-14 Saved text styles **MUST**

Named looks such as "Heading" and "Body text" are applied by a single click. Changing a saved style updates every piece of text using it, throughout the document.

Done when: changing the size of "Body text" updates all 40 pages, and the user is shown how many items changed.

TXT-15 Spell check SHOULD

Misspellings are marked as the user types, with corrections offered on click. The user can add words to a personal dictionary.

Done when: marks do not appear in the exported PDF and do not interfere with selection.

5.3 Photographs IMG**IMG-01 Add a photo** MUST

Two routes, both prominent: a large "Add photo" button opening the file picker, and dragging a file from the desktop onto the page. Per GL-04 the button route is sufficient alone.

Done when: a first-time user adds a photo from their own computer within 60 seconds, without instruction.

IMG-02 Sensible placement on arrival MUST

A newly added photo appears at a reasonable size and position — never filling the whole page, never microscopic, never off-screen.

Done when: photos of ten widely differing dimensions all arrive well placed and fully visible.

IMG-03 Trim a photo MUST

Part of a photo can be cut away, with a clear preview of what is kept and what is removed, and a single "Undo trim" that restores the whole image.

Done when: trimming is reversible at any later time without loss of the original.

IMG-04 Turn and flip MUST

Photos can be turned in 90-degree steps by button, set to any angle by typed value, straightened by a small amount using a slider, and mirrored horizontally or vertically.

Done when: all four operations combine correctly and export accurately to PDF.

IMG-05 Photo quality warning MUST

If a photo is too low in quality to print well at its current size, a plain-language warning appears on the photo — for example, "This photo may look blurry when printed. Try making it smaller or using a larger photo."

Done when: the warning appears and disappears correctly as the photo is resized past the threshold.

IMG-06 Replace a photo SHOULD

A photo can be swapped for another while keeping its position, size, and trim.

Done when: replacing a trimmed photo preserves the frame and applies a sensible equivalent trim.

IMG-07 Rounded corners SHOULD

Photo corners can be rounded by a slider, including fully circular.

Done when: rounding renders identically on screen and in the exported PDF.

IMG-08 See-through SHOULD

Any item can be made partly see-through by a labelled slider running from solid to invisible.

Done when: the effect matches between screen and export within a visually indistinguishable margin.

IMG-09 Text flows around a photo SHOULD

Text can be set to flow around a photo rather than beneath it, with an adjustable gap.

Done when: flowing text avoids the photo correctly across a connected chain of boxes (TXT-12).

IMG-10 Photo library, adjustments, background removal LATER

Built-in stock photographs, brightness and contrast adjustment, filters, and automatic background removal.

Done when: deferred to Phase B.

5.4 Shapes and lines SHP**SHP-01 Basic shapes** MUST

Rectangle, circle, and straight line, each added by a single labelled button.

Done when: each is added, moved, resized, and coloured, and exports accurately.

SHP-02 Colour inside and outline MUST

Every shape has a fill colour and an outline with adjustable colour and thickness. Either can be switched off entirely.

Done when: a shape with no fill and a 3pt outline exports correctly.

SHP-03 Rounded corners on shapes SHOULD

Rectangle corners can be rounded by a slider.

Done when: rounding renders identically on screen and in export.

SHP-04 Arrows, icons, shadows LATER

Arrow shapes, an icon and illustration library, and drop shadows.

Done when: deferred to Phase B.

5.5 Arranging things ARR**ARR-01 Select an item** MUST

A single click selects. The selected item is marked with a clearly visible outline and handles of at least 14 pixels.

Done when: the selection outline is visible against white, black, and busy photographic backgrounds.

ARR-02 Select several items MUST

Multiple items are selected by holding a modifier key and clicking, and by a "Select all on this page" command. A drag-rectangle is offered additionally, never exclusively.

Done when: multi-selection is achieved without any drag.

ARR-03 Move an item MUST

By dragging; by arrow keys moving 1 unit, or 10 units with a modifier held; and by typing exact position values in a panel.

Done when: all three methods produce identical results and each is fully undoable.

ARR-04 Resize an item MUST

By corner and edge handles, and by typing exact width and height. Photographs keep their proportions unless the user explicitly unlocks them.

Done when: a photo cannot be accidentally stretched out of proportion by a corner handle.

ARR-05 Turn an item to any angle MUST

By a rotate handle and by typing degrees. Holding a modifier snaps to 15-degree steps.

Done when: both methods agree and the result exports accurately.

ARR-06 Lining-up guides **MUST**

While an item is being moved, guides appear showing alignment with page edges, margins, and other items, and the item snaps gently to them. Guides disappear when the move ends.

Done when: guides appear for edges, centres, and equal spacing between three or more items.

ARR-07 Line up several items **MUST**

Buttons align selected items left, centre, right, top, middle, or bottom.

Done when: each of the six operates correctly on a selection of mixed item types.

ARR-08 Space items evenly **SHOULD**

Buttons distribute three or more selected items evenly, horizontally or vertically.

Done when: gaps between items are equal to within one unit.

ARR-09 Bring to front, send to back **MUST**

Four labelled buttons: bring to front, bring forward, send backward, send to back.

Done when: stacking order changes correctly and matches the exported PDF.

ARR-10 Lock an item **MUST**

An item can be locked so it cannot be moved or changed by accident. Locked items show a clear marker and are unlocked by an obvious button.

Done when: a locked item resists all move, resize, and delete attempts, and the user is told why.

ARR-11 Copy, paste, duplicate, delete **MUST**

All four available as labelled buttons and as standard keyboard shortcuts. Pasted items appear slightly offset from the original so they are visible.

Done when: items copy correctly between pages and between documents.

ARR-12 Group items **SHOULD**

Several items can be joined so they move and resize together, and separated again.

Done when: grouping and ungrouping preserve exact positions and sizes.

ARR-13 Copy the look of an item **SHOULD**

A "Copy look" button applies one item's formatting to another.

Done when: formatting transfers between two text boxes and between two shapes.

5.6 Colour CLR**CLR-01 Colour chooser** **MUST**

One consistent colour chooser used everywhere. It shows, in order: the document palette, recently used colours, a set of standard colours, and a full picker behind a "More colours" control.

Done when: the identical chooser appears for text, shape fill, outline, and page background.

CLR-02 Document palette **MUST**

A small set of colours saved with the document and offered first everywhere, so a user keeps a consistent look without effort.

Done when: palette colours persist across sessions and appear first in every chooser.

CLR-03 Recently used colours MUST

The last eight colours used are always available.

Done when: the list updates immediately and survives a page reload.

CLR-04 Pick a colour from a photo SHOULD

A tool picks any colour from a photograph on the page and applies it, so text can be matched to an image.

Done when: the picked colour matches the source pixel exactly.

CLR-05 Suggested palettes LATER

Ready-made colour combinations that work well together.

Done when: deferred to Phase B.

5.7 Getting it out OUT**OUT-01 Download for printing** MUST

Produces a PDF meeting professional print requirements, accepted by a commercial print shop without complaint.

Done when: a real print shop accepts and correctly prints the output from three different test documents.

OUT-02 Download for email or screen MUST

Produces a smaller PDF suitable for emailing and reading on screen, with text remaining selectable.

Done when: a 24-page document produces a file small enough to email comfortably.

OUT-03 Checks before downloading MUST

Before producing a print file, the product checks for hidden text, low-quality photos, and items too close to the page edge, and reports any problems in plain words with a way to jump straight to each one.

Done when: each problem type is detected reliably and clicking it navigates to the affected item.

OUT-04 Download pages as pictures SHOULD

Individual pages can be saved as image files for use on a website or social media.

Done when: exported images match the on-screen appearance exactly.

OUT-05 Print directly SHOULD

A Print button sends the document to a home printer with correct sizing and no unexpected scaling.

Done when: a physical print measures correctly on two different printer models.

OUT-06 Sharing links and collaboration LATER

Share links, simultaneous editing, and comments.

Done when: deferred to Phase B.

5.8 Help HLP

HLP-01 Reopenable guided tour **MUST**

A short walkthrough of the main functions, available at any time from a permanently visible Help button — never a one-time overlay that cannot be recovered.

Done when: the tour can be started, left, and restarted from any point in the product.

HLP-02 Help on every panel **MUST**

Every panel has a help control explaining what its controls do, in plain words, with a picture where useful.

Done when: every panel has help text reviewed against the Section 8 vocabulary.

HLP-03 Interface text size setting **MUST**

A prominent setting makes all interface text larger, up to the GL-02 maximum. It is offered on first use, not buried in preferences.

Done when: the setting is found by a first-time user without assistance, and persists between sessions.

6. Deliberately excluded from Phase A

Each item below is genuinely useful and each is excluded on purpose. Every feature is surface area for defects, and the goal for Phase A is a small product that works flawlessly rather than a large one that mostly works. Do not re-propose these without a decision to change scope.

EXCLUDED	REASON
Background removal	Substantial engineering and inference cost, unpredictable results, not required to make a newsletter.
Photo filters and adjustments	Large surface area, high defect risk, marginal benefit for print work.
Curved and shaped text	Significant text-engine complexity for a decorative effect.
Drop shadows and effects	Complicates print output, particularly transparency handling.
Icon and illustration library	Licensing, curation, and search cost. Users can add their own images.
Simultaneous editing	The single largest source of engineering risk in the product. Our primary user works alone.
Comments and suggestions	Depends on simultaneous editing.
Version history	Autosave plus reliable undo covers the real need for Phase A.
Stock photo library	Licensing cost and complexity.
Mobile and tablet editing	Viewing on mobile is fine; editing on a small screen conflicts directly with every principle in Section 3.

7. Quality bar and parallel work

The intention is to build with several workstreams running at once, each owning a small area. That approach only produces reliable software if the boundaries between areas are explicit. This section defines them.

7.1 Definition of done

A requirement is complete only when every one of the following is true. Partial completion is not completion, and a requirement that fails any line below is not ready to merge.

1. The **Done when** criterion is demonstrated, not asserted.
2. An automated test covers the criterion and runs in the build pipeline.
3. The feature is fully undoable and redoable.
4. The feature is operable by keyboard alone.

5. The feature is operable without any drag.
6. All user-facing text passes the Section 8 vocabulary scan.
7. Every control meets GL-01 and GL-02.
8. The feature works at 200% browser zoom.
9. Every error path shows a plain-language message with a next step.
10. The feature has been used by someone outside the team to complete a real task.

7.2 Ownership boundaries

Areas are split so that two workstreams rarely need to change the same file. Shared surfaces are the exception and are handled differently.

SURFACE	OWNERSHIP	RULE
Document structure	Single owner	Changes are proposed, reviewed, and merged one at a time. Never edited by two workstreams concurrently.
Action registry	Single owner	A workstream may <i>add</i> new actions freely. Modifying an existing action requires coordination.
Toolbar shell	Single owner	Positions are fixed by GL-09. Features register into slots; they do not restructure the toolbar.
Drawing core	Single owner	Features add item types; they do not alter the drawing pipeline.
Feature panels	Feature owner	Each feature owns its own panel outright and may change it freely.
Feature actions	Feature owner	Each feature owns the actions it introduces.
Vocabulary list	Single owner	Additions are proposed centrally so that terminology stays consistent across features.

7.3 Rules for parallel workstreams

- A workstream owns whole requirement IDs, never parts of one. **TXT-12** is one person's or one agent's responsibility from start to finish.
- No workstream modifies another's panel or actions. If a change is needed there, it is requested, not made.
- Adding to a shared surface is permitted; changing existing behaviour on a shared surface is not, without coordination.
- Every workstream runs the full global-requirements check (Section 4) before merging, not only its own tests.
- The primary acceptance test (2.4) runs against every merge to the main branch. If it breaks, the merge is reverted rather than patched forward.
- Requirements marked **LATER** are not started, not scaffolded, and not designed for. Speculative structure for deferred work is a defect.

ON THE 99% TARGET

Reliability comes from small scope and hard acceptance criteria, not from effort or from the number of workstreams. Adding parallel capacity to an under-specified requirement produces more defects, not fewer — because each workstream fills the gaps in the specification differently, and the seams between them are where the bugs live.

The highest-leverage action available is therefore to make every **Done when** line in this document sharp enough that two independent workstreams reading it would build the same thing.

8. Approved vocabulary

These are the only permitted terms in user-facing text. The left column must not appear anywhere the user can see it — not in labels, tooltips, help, error messages, or menus. This list is enforced by an automated scan in the build pipeline (GL-08).

NEVER SAY	SAY INSTEAD
Opacity, alpha, transparency	See-through
Kerning, tracking	Letter spacing
Leading, line height	Line spacing
Z-index, layer order, stacking	Bring to front / Send to back
Bleed	Extra edge for printing
CMYK, colour space, colour profile	Print colours
DPI, PPI, resolution	Photo quality
Crop	Trim
Stroke	Outline
Fill	Colour inside
Justify, justified	Straight edges both sides
Thread, flow, link frames	Continue in another box
Overflow, overset	Some text is hidden
Master page, parent page	Repeating background
Baseline grid, guides, snapping	Lining-up guides
Export, render, generate	Download / Save as / Print
Canvas, artboard	Page
Element, object, asset, node	Item / Photo / Text / Shape
Font family, typeface, glyph	Font
Spread	Two pages side by side
Style sheet, paragraph style	Saved look
Rotate, transform	Turn
Aspect ratio, constrain proportions	Keep the shape

Template, master	Ready-made design
Undo history, transaction	Undo

9. Validating with real users

Nothing in this document is worth anything until it has been tested with the people it is for. Design review inside the team consistently fails to catch the problems that matter, because everyone on the team already knows how the product works.

9.1 Schedule

WHEN	WHAT
Before building	Paper or clickable prototype tested with five people aged 70+. Confirms layout and vocabulary before any code is written.
After each area	One session per completed area, testing that area's tasks specifically.
Before release	Full primary acceptance test (2.4) with five fresh participants who have never seen the product.
One week later	The same participants repeat the task, confirming the tool is memorable and not merely learnable.

9.2 How to run a session

- Give the participant a real goal — "make a two-page newsletter about your garden club" — not a list of steps.
- Do not help, hint, or explain. Where they get stuck is the entire finding.
- Record where they hesitate, what they click that does nothing, and what words they use for things.
- Any term a participant does not recognise goes into Section 8 as a forbidden term.
- Three or more participants failing the same step makes it a defect, not a training problem.

10. Decisions still open

Each of these affects work in Phase A and should be settled before the corresponding area is started.

#	QUESTION	WHY IT MATTERS
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1	Print-first or screen-first?	Print requires professional colour handling, extra edges, and pre-download checks, and roughly doubles the output work. Screen-first drops all of it. This gates OUT-01 and OUT-03 and has been open since the project began.
2	How many ready-made designs at launch?	DOC-02 assumes at least six. These must be designed, not coded, and are on the critical path.
3	Can users upload their own fonts?	TXT-04 brings licence checking and legal exposure. Shipping a curated list only is materially simpler.
4	Which languages at launch?	Affects spell check, hyphenation, and the vocabulary list, which must be translated rather than converted word for word.
5	Where are documents stored?	Determines whether the product works without an internet connection — a real consideration for the target user.
6	Who runs the user sessions in Section 9?	Recruiting five participants aged 70+ takes real time and needs an owner now, not when testing is due.

NEXT STEP

Settle open decision 1, then break Section 5 into individual work items — one per requirement ID — and confirm that each line is precise enough that two independent workstreams would build the same thing from it.